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VC VALUATIONS

In the 3-way AI horse race, OpenAI remains firmly in the lead

By [Jacob Robbins](#)

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When it comes to funding, [OpenAI](#) remains far ahead of its two closest competitors, [Anthropic](#) and [xAI](#), underscoring the ongoing concentration of investor capital among a small number of companies.

To date, OpenAI has secured \$66.4 billion from investors. [The New York Times](#) reported Friday that it raised another \$8.3 billion as part of the [record \\$40 billion fundraising](#)

[commitment](#) it secured in March that catapulted it behind [SpaceX](#) to be the second most valuable VC-backed company.

OpenAI's domineering lead

Fundraising totals over time



Valuation over time



Source: PitchBook • As of Aug. 1, 2025

*These rounds for Anthropic and xAI are not confirmed

OpenAI’s second closet competitor, xAI, has only raised a third of the capital, and it is worth a little more than a fourth of the former’s most recent \$300 billion valuation.

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But xAI’s leapfrogging of Anthropic is an achievement: The Elon Musk-led startup is half as old as Anthropic, but has raised almost double the capital.

Anthropic is reportedly looking to raise around \$5 billion, which would bring its valuation to \$170 billion and make it the fifth most valuable VC-backed company.

Seeking to raise \$10 billion, xAI would remain as the fourth most valuable VC-backed company and have netted nearly half of all OpenAI’s funding.

But even if these deals are completed, OpenAI would remain far ahead.

Featured image by Mara Potter/PitchBook News

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About [Jacob Robbins](#)

Reporter Jacob Robbins covers artificial intelligence and the venture capital ecosystem for PitchBook. Based in Seattle, Jacob is originally from Massachusetts and holds dual degrees in political science and cinema studies from the American University. His work has previously appeared in Air Mail and Business Insider.

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